Hack-a-Claw x NVIDIA @ UCSC

MAY
15

Friday, May 15
6:00 PM - May 16, 9:00 PM

Kresge Academic Building ↗
Santa Cruz, CA

Presented by
NVIDIA >

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Starting in 4h 6m

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Hosted By

- Lisa Hoang
- Preet Karia
- Hack.Dev
- Ethan Einhorn

265 Going

Holden Martinez, Jiaqi Zhang and 263 others

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About Event

About the Event

Autonomous AI agents are running on laptops, connecting to real tools, and completing real tasks. Now it's your turn to build one.

In this 24-hour hackathon hosted by NVIDIA, your challenge is to build a working autonomous agent application using OpenClaw and NVIDIA Nemotron models. We want agents that take action, handle live data, and execute complex multi-step workflows. The use case is yours to define.

The Deliverable

Your submission needs to be a deployed, working OpenClaw agent powered by Nemotron that autonomously handles a task with persistent memory, multi-step reasoning, and live tool use. Not a prototype. Not a pitch deck. Something that runs.

Choose Your Compute Path

- **On-device:** Build locally on ASUS Ascent GX10 (DGX Spark).
- **Cloud:** Build via fully sponsored compute instances on NVIDIA Brev.

The Three Prize Tracks

- **Cloud Track:** Brev-driven project for OpenClaw and NVIDIA Nemotron Models.
- **Edge Track:** ASUS Ascent GX10-driven project for OpenClaw and NVIDIA Nemotron Models.
- **Bonus Track (Best Use of NemoClaw):** Want to go further? Deploy your agent using NVIDIA NemoClaw for an additional prize category. NemoClaw wraps your OpenClaw agent in a hardened sandbox with policy-based security and privacy guardrails, running Nemotron locally on-device. Teams that deploy via NemoClaw and demonstrate its security controls will be judged separately for this track. *(Note: NemoClaw is currently in early preview so some rough edges are expected)*.

The Details

- **Who:** Open to UC Santa Cruz students of all experience levels. No prior OpenClaw experience required. A getting-started guide will be shared before the event. You can work in teams of 1-4.
- **Food:** Fully catered for 24 hours. Energy, caffeine, and meals are on us.
- **Title Sponsors:** NVIDIA, ASUS, Baskin School of Engineering.

Prizes:

- **The ASUS Ascent (DGX Spark)** (Valued at $4000)
- **Jetson Nano Orins**
- **Exclusive Premium NVIDIA Swag**
- **High-Value** Brev.dev **Compute Credits**
- **Career Fast-Tracking:** Direct portfolio reviews and internship pipeline opportunities with NVIDIA Hiring Managers

Space is strictly capped at 200 builders. Registration requires application approval. Apply below.

Application deadline is May 13 1:00 PM. Decisions will be released later that night.

Event Sponsor:

NVIDIA Privacy Policy: https://www.nvidia.com/en-us/about-nvidia/privacy-policy/

Blasts

Lisa Hoang Yesterday, 1:09 PM

It's almost time! Everything you need to know for the Hack-a-Claw

Hey builders,

You're in. Here's everything you need to know before you show up.

Kickoff: Friday, May 15 at 6:00pm

Pencils down, judging starts: Saturday, May 16 at 6:00pm

Location: Kresge Academic Building

The Challenge

You have 24 hours to build a deployed, working autonomous agent using OpenClaw, Hermes Agent, or like and NVIDIA Nemotron models. We want agents that take action, handle live data, and execute complex multi-step workflows; not prototypes, not pitch decks, not slides. Something that actually runs.

The use case is yours to define.

Pick Your Compute Path

- **Edge Track** — Build on-device using the ASUS Ascent GX10 (DGX Spark), available on-site

- **Cloud Track** — Build on fully sponsored compute instances via NVIDIA Brev

You'll choose your track when you arrive and it's first come first serve. Both are fully supported.

The Three Prize Tracks

- **Edge Track** (ASUS Ascent GX10): Best project built on the ASUS Ascent GX10 using OpenClaw and NVIDIA Nemotron

- **Cloud Track** (Brev GPU Credits): Best project built on NVIDIA Brev using OpenClaw and NVIDIA Nemotron

- **Bonus Track — Best Use of NemoClaw: Deploy your agent inside NVIDIA NemoClaw for a hardened sandbox with policy-based security and privacy guardrails running Nemotron locally. Demonstrate the security controls in your submission to qualify. Note: NemoClaw is in early preview, so expect some rough edges. Use our agent for support.

Other prizes include:

- Exclusive premium NVIDIA swag + NVIDIA Jetson Orin Nano

- Direct portfolio reviews and internship pipeline opportunities with NVIDIA Hiring Managers

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To Be Eligible for Prizes

Your submission must:

- Be a fully functional autonomous agent built with OpenClaw or Hermes Agent

- Use NVIDIA Nemotron models via build.nvidia.com/models (cloud track)

- Demonstrate live tool use and independent action

Check out nvidia.com/clawhelp and shortesthack.com for helpful resources to prep.

Logistics

- Teams of 1 to 4 people

- Fully catered for 24 hours — meals, caffeine, and energy are on us

- Space is capped at 250 builders

- Title sponsors: NVIDIA, ASUS, Baskin School of Engineering

See you there.

Location

Kresge Academic Building

498, 510 Porter-Kresge Rd, Santa Cruz, CA 95064, USA